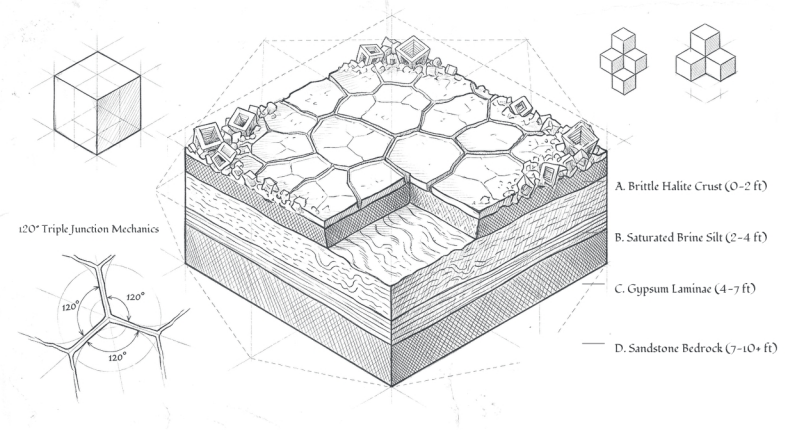
Study on the Dry Salt Playa

I. Mechanical Principles of Crust Buckling & Desiccation

As solar heat bakes the playa, capillary suction pulls saturated brine up through fissures.
Crystallizing salt expands by volume, forcing polygon plate edges to buckle into sharp ridges.
Where subterranean waters dissolve the silt from beneath, treacherous sinkholes form unseen.
The traveler must test every slab before bearing full weight, as dry crusts conceal deep brine.

Fig. I - Morphological Cutaway of the Salt Playa & Halite Crystallography



II. The Architect's Note (Field Codex Entry):

«The water that flows carries the memory of the heights; but the salt that remains
is the crystal skeleton of the earth, holding the light long after the storm has turned to dust.
Let the seeker who traverses the playa walk with measured footsteps,
for weight without balance yields perpetually to the deep beneath.»

